MUMBAI POLICE

THE PLOT THICKENS

THE PROTAGONISTS

PARAM BIR SINGH
FORMER MUMBAI POLICE COMMISSIONER

Once a favourite of top politicians, the 1988 batch IPS officer was unceremoniously removed as police chief on March 17, 2021 after investigations made it apparent that his trusted aide, Sachin Vaze, was involved in the Ambani bomb scare case. Singh, who was later appointed DG of Maharashtra Home Guard, went missing for 289 days. He was suspended on December 3, 2021 for dereliction of duty.

THE CHARGES: As head of Mumbai Police Establishment Board, Singh had reinstated Vaze on June 6, 2020 despite a tainted record. Singh made Vaze head of Mumbai police's Crime Intelligence Unit (CIU) on June 9, 2020 by allegedly ignoring rules. He allegedly allowed Vaze to bypass senior officers and directly report to him.

HIS DEFENCE: In an affidavit before the Enforcement Directorate (ED) in December 2021, Singh claimed that Chief Minister Uddhav Thackeray and his son Aaditya had pressured him to reinstate Vaze.

LEGAL POSITION: Singh will have to provide evidence to prove his allegations against the Thackerays. He also faces action in five extortion cases.

THE STATUS: Singh remains under suspension. He had surfaced in Mumbai last year after long absence from work but has moved back to hometown Chandigarh.



ANIL DESHMUKH
FORMER MAHARASHTRA HOME MINISTER

The veteran NCP leader became the first high-profile casualty, stepping down on April 5, 2021 after the Bombay High Court directed the CBI to probe corruption allegations made against him by Param Bir Singh. The ED arrested Deshmukh on November 1, 2021 in a case of alleged money-laundering.

THE CHARGES: Deshmukh allegedly asked Vaze and others to extort Rs 100 crore a month from bar/ restaurant owners in Mumbai. In a supplementary chargesheet filed before a special PMLA (Prevention of Money Laundering Act) court in December 2021, the ED claimed Deshmukh had diverted Rs 4.70 crore worth of extorted money to his family-controlled Sai Shikshan Sanstha in Nagpur.

HIS DEFENCE: Deshmukh told the Justice K.U. Chandiwal Commission, which is investigating the extortion case, that he did not know Vaze personally. He claimed Param Bir Singh had masterminded the planting of explosives near Mukesh Ambani's home, and that the officer was removed as Mumbai police chief for concealing facts in the case.

LEGAL POSITION: Deshmukh will have to prove that the source of money transferred to the Sai Shikshan Sanstha was legal.

THE STATUS: Deshmukh is lodged in Mumbai's Arthur Road jail in the money-laundering case.

